

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT
POLICY MANUAL
VOLUME 2 -EMPLOYEE MANUAL
Policy: 202.06 Training Records

11/2023

PURPOSE

The purpose of the Training Records Policy is to ensure that all training is accurately documented. Accurate training records provide means of analyzing the departments over all training programs. Accurate training records provide essential information for Insurance Services Office (ISO) raters when the City of Calimesa Fire Department is graded.

POLICY

Personnel will record training activities by documenting and submitting training hours on the training forms and or by entering the required information into the appropriate electronic records management/training platform being utilized by the Department.

The company officer is responsible for ensuring that the training of those employees and other members under his supervision is recorded via the recognized training documentation platform(s).

Training in Fire Technology received in outside classes and seminars will also require employees to submit a training entry.

College courses exceeding 40 hours classroom instruction should be forwarded to the Training Battalion Chief/Captain and recorded on an employee-training log and/or entered the appropriate training records management platform.

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Policy: 202.07 Helmet Camera and Recording Devices

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PURPOSE

The purpose of the Helmet Camera and Recording Devices policy is to ensure that all members of the Calimesa Fire Department respect the privacy of the public when responding to an incident.

POLICY

Use of helmet camera and recording devices is prohibited while on duty. The Calimesa Fire Department wants to ensure the citizens that when we respond to an incident that we will not be recording any part of the incident. The Calimesa Fire Department respects the privacy of all citizens we serve.

Helmet cameras and recording devices can be used in training scenarios with the written permission of the Battalion Chief, Deputy Chief or Fire Chief.

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Policy: 202.08 Incident/ Medical Reports

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PURPOSE

To provide standards for the preparation of fire incident reports, emergency medical service reports and all other incident reports.

To document incidents which fire department personnel respond to and render services to or make patient contact.

POLICY

Fire personnel will complete incident reports for all emergency responses to which they are dispatched. Personnel will utilize current Records Management System software to input incident reports.

The preparation of incident reports shall be the responsibility of the highest-ranking Officer who has knowledge of the overall operations at the emergency scene or as directed by a Company Officer to write the incident report.

Fire incident reports will be completed for all fire incidents. The responsibility of completing fire incident reports will be as follows:

- Single engine response: The Fire Captain, (or designee) will complete the fire report.
- Multi-engine response or a working fire with hydrant supply lines: The first on scene Fire Captain, (or designee) will complete the fire report or the Company Officer will complete the required fire reports with the assistance of the on-scene Fire Captain, (or designee).
- Mutual aid fires: The Fire Captain, (or designee) or Company Officer will complete the incident report. The fire report will be the responsibility of the agency that requested mutual aid.

All NFIRS and EMS reports shall be completed by the highest-ranking personnel in charge of patient care.

All Medical Reports shall be protected from public disclosure in accordance with the HIPAA regulations and the California Confidentiality of Medical Information Act (“CCMIA”) (Cal. Civil Code § 56 et seq.).

Members of the Fire Department shall strictly comply with all applicable HIPAA regulations and provisions of the CCMIA .

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All incident reports shall be completed and submitted during the regular tour of duty. Major incidents requiring an unusual amount of paperwork may be submitted on the next regularly scheduled tour of duty.

All incidents requiring investigation or other reports by outside agencies will be completed by the end of the regular tour of duty following the completion and receipt of outside agency reports.

Battalion Chiefs shall regularly review and conduct “Spot Checks,” of all report submissions for thoroughness, accuracy, grammar, punctuation, and content.

The Fire Chief (or Deputy Fire Chief) will have the overall responsibility of reviewing all incident reports for completeness and quality control.

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Policy: 202.09 Reporting for Duty and Roll Call

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PURPOSE

The purpose of the Reporting for Duty and Roll Call Policy is to establish a structure to account for the presence of all scheduled and on-duty Fire Department Personnel.

POLICY

All on-duty Fire Department Staff shall report to roll call in their complete class B uniform or other designated uniform (as may be designated or modified by the duty battalion chief) at 0700 hours.

It shall be the responsibility of the on-duty Fire Captain to advise the on-duty Fire Department Staff of the location of the roll call meeting.

Upon completion of roll call, the on-duty Fire Captain shall initiate a safety briefing to the on-duty crew. The safety briefing shall be held for a minimum of 10 minutes and no longer than 30 minutes.

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Policy: 202.10 Maximum Consecutive Work Shift (24-hours)

11/2023

PURPOSE

This Policy establishes the guidelines relating to the Maximum Number of Consecutive 24-Hour shifts, an employee serving in a fire suppression position can work at the Calimesa Fire Department.

It is a concern of both the Fire Administration and members of the medical community that fatigue caused by extended periods of inadequate rest may impair job performance. This may be the result of fire suppression personnel working consecutive shifts and the level of activity, both routine and emergency which was encountered during those shifts. Fatigue may affect performance in such critical areas as tactical size-up, deployment of companies, basic life support skills and defensive driving techniques. In addition, and most importantly, the ongoing and deliberate efforts in the area of safety consciousness may be adversely affected.

POLICY

Employees and interns/reserves serving in fire suppression positions shall generally not work more than four (4) consecutive 24-hour shifts. In instances where four (4) consecutive shifts are worked, the employee should generally be scheduled to be off duty for a full 24 hours before working again. Subject to the prior approval of the Fire Chief, it is the member's responsibility to schedule his/her extra work time, whether constant staffing or absences with relief, so that this policy is not violated, and the member is available and eligible to work the regularly assigned shift.

In extreme cases, department members may be required to provide Constant Staffing as required by Policy 101.04. as a result of participation in strike team deployments and the required backfill to provide constant staffing within the City. These situations will be considered individually on a case-by-case basis and exceptions may be granted by approval from the Fire Chief.

This policy shall not apply to the rank of Battalion Chief/Deputy Fire Marshal, Deputy Fire Chief, or Fire Chief. Additionally, this policy shall not apply to those deployed or assigned to "expanded incidents" such as strike teams or other similar tasks where work rest ratios may be regulated by the Incident Management Team.

In the event that a member would have to pass up a constant staffing shift due to this policy, he/she will not be charged with a "refusal" or a "pass"; however, it will be the individual member's responsibility to obtain the Scheduling Battalion Chief prior approval of any schedule in conflict with this policy when the member is called to constant staff.

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Policy: 202.11 Shift Exchange

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PURPOSE

The purpose of the Shift Exchange Policy is to provide Department members with the opportunity to trade shifts on a one-time basis while ensuring that all staff conform to Department policies regarding assignments and overtime.

POLICY

A shift exchange means approval by the Fire Chief, Deputy Fire Chief, or assigned Duty Battalion Chief for one fire protection employee to trade his/her regularly assigned 48-hour shift or a 24-hour work period with another fire protection employee on a one-time basis.

Shift exchanges that would result in either firefighter working overtime shall not be permitted. All shift exchanges are subject to the prior approval of the Fire Chief, Deputy Fire Chief, or Duty Battalion Chief, and shall conform with Department Procedure(s).

Shift exchanges are a privilege, which are designed to allow employees time off when other means are unavailable. An employee's shift exchange privilege may be suspended or revoked if Department Procedures are violated.

Probationary firefighters may only start exchanging shifts three (3) months after satisfactorily working in an operations assignment.

Management, at its sole discretion, may discontinue this policy at any time, without notice.

GUIDELINES

Members within the same classification may be granted the opportunity to exchange shifts up to a maximum of three (3) per employee in a month, after their probationary period of three (3) months.

EXAMPLE:

Staff Member A requests a shift exchange with Staff Member B for March 3rd. Staff Member A must repay the shift exchange within the month of March to Staff Member B. All shift exchanges between members must be complete within the same monthly period.

PROCEDURE

A Fire Department member may submit a written request for approval of a shift exchange with another Fire Department member. The written request shall be submitted via their immediate chain of command in accordance with the procedure listed below. In order to be eligible for a shift

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exchange, both Fire Department members shall have identical job classifications and qualifications; and both members shall voluntarily agree to participate in the shift exchange. A proposed shift exchange shall not be approved if it results in either member working overtime.

It is the responsibility of the employee requesting a shift exchange to ensure that the Shift Exchange form (Form 401.07) is properly completed and signed by both the requesting employee and by the employee who has agreed to provide relief, their assigned Captain and the scheduling Battalion Chief

The employee requesting the shift exchange shall be responsible for submitting the completed form to his/her immediate supervisor.

It is the requesting employee's responsibility to ensure all shift exchanges are repaid within the monthly time frame. It is also the employee's responsibility to ensure that a proposed shift exchange does not conflict with the maximum consecutive work shift procedure (Policy No. 202.10) or that the proposed shift exchange would result in either employee working overtime (Policy No. 102.09).

After approval by the immediate supervisor, the employee will forward (via mail if time permits, or hand carry) the completed Shift Exchange form to his/her assigned Fire Captain and Battalion Chief for final approval. No shift exchange shall be effective until approved in writing by the immediate supervisor and the Battalion Chief .

The employee shall be responsible for delivering the Shift Exchange form with supervisor's approval, to the scheduling Battalion Chief not less than five (5) consecutive days (1-shift) prior to the effective date of the proposed shift exchange.

The scheduling Battalion Chief may waive the time limits in cases of emergency, but in all cases the Shift Exchange form must be approved by the employee's immediate supervisor and Battalion Chief prior to the shift exchange being worked by the requesting employee.

When the employee agreeing to work the shift signs the Shift Exchange form, FULL RESPONSIBILITY FOR THAT SHIFT is thereafter the responsibility of that employee. If for any reason he/she is unable to work the shift, it is his or her responsibility to find someone qualified to work the shift instead and make sure that the completed form is timely submitted to and approved by his/her immediate supervisor and Battalion Chief prior to the three-day (1-shift) minimum time deadline.

If the employee who is to provide relief is on unpaid leave or is no longer employed by the Department, responsibility for the shift returns to the employee originally requesting relief and he/she shall work the shift as originally assigned. In such event, the employee originally requesting

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the shift exchange shall provide a revised Shift Exchange Form to his/her immediate supervisor and the scheduling Battalion Chief prior to the commencement of the shift.

FAILURE TO PROVIDE RELIEF WILL RESULT IN A LOSS OF PAID TIME OFF EQUAL TO THE COST OF FILLING THAT POSITION, AND MAY RESULT IN THE LOSS OF THE EMPLOYEE'S SHIFT EXCHANGE PRIVILEGE AND/OR OTHER DISCIPLINARY ACTION.

SCHEDULING BATTALION CHIEF RESPONSIBILITIES

It is the responsibility of the Scheduling Battalion Chief to approve or disapprove a proposed shift exchange and to file the completed form in the Shift trade log and or electronic scheduling platform.

A shift trade logbook will be kept in the Duty Battalion Chiefs Office for immediate reference and documentation of all authorized shift trades.

PARTIAL SHIFT

Partial shift exchanges may be allowable in twelve-hour increments: 0700 – 1900 or 1900 to 0700 with the same applicable approval requirements and guidelines as set forth for in this policy.

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Policy: 202.12 Information Systems: Electronic Communication and Internet Usage Policy

11/2023

PURPOSE

The purpose of the Information Systems: Electronic Communication and Internet Usage Policy is to provide guidelines and requirements for the use of City electronic communications. E-mail, Internet, and Intranet are important tools that assist us in providing excellent customer service.

This policy supplements the City-wide policy regarding use of City information systems (Rule 7 of the City of Calimesa Personnel Rules). In the event that the City of Calimesa adopts or updates its policy, rules or procedures relating to information systems, the terms of that policy shall take precedence as used herein, “information systems” means all E-mail, Internet, Intranet, electronic and social media, and telephone systems, and all other electronic communications on City accounts, servers, software, and hardware.

POLICY

It is the policy of the City that all City computers, E-mails, Internet, Intranet, electronic and social media, and telephone systems, and other electronic communications on City accounts, servers, software, and hardware, are to be used for City-related business and official purposes only. All City Information Systems, including but not limited to hardware, software, databases, E-mail, mailbox messages, spreadsheets, files, and documents and writings of any kind whatsoever sent, received or created on or using City information systems, are the property of the City of Calimesa. The City reserves the right to retrieve and make proper and lawful use and/or disclosure of any and all communications transmitted through any City-provided information system.

As used in this Policy, “writing” includes any handwriting, typewriting, printing, Photostatting, photocopying, photographing, transmitting by electronic mail or facsimile, and every other means of recording upon any tangible thing any form of communication or representation including letters, words, pictures, sounds, or symbols, or combinations thereof, as well as all papers, maps, magnetic or paper tapes, photographic films and prints, and text messages, and as otherwise defined in the California Public Records Act, Cal. Gov. Code § 6250 et seq., as amended from time to time.

Employees are responsible for any information or other writings that they generate or distribute through any City information system.

City-assigned passwords or other security devices shall not be shared with or disclosed to any other City employee or official, without the express written authority of the City Manager. Under no circumstances shall a City-assigned password or other security device be shared with spouses, relatives, or any other third party. Employees shall take all reasonable steps to prevent the unauthorized use of the City’s Internet, E-mail systems and other information systems while logged into the City’s network by using password-protected screen savers or other appropriate